PEW RESEARCH CENTER NEWS INTEREST INDEX
JANUARY 13-16, 2011 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,000

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
January 13-16, 2010	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1
December 16-19, 2010	39	31	14	15	2
December 9-12, 2010	39	30	14	16	1
December 2-5, 2010	52	28	11	9	*
November 18-21, 2010	46	31	11	11	*
November 11-14, 2010	38	30	15	16	1
November 4-7, 2010	44	32	11	13	*
October 28-November 1, 2010	39	34	11	15	1
October 21-24, 2010	41	29	14	14	1
October 14-17, 2010	42	33	12	13	*
October 7-10, 2010	36	33	15	15	1
September 30-October 3, 2010	43	35	10	11	1
September 23-26, 2010	43	34	13	9	1
September 16-19, 2010	37	30	16	16	1
September 2-6, 2010	43	31	13	12	*
August 19-22, 2010	39	31	14	15	1
August 5-8, 2010	39	33	14	13	1
July 29-August 1, 2010	51	33	11	5	*
July 22-25, 2010	46	33	14	6	1
July 15-18, 2010	37	33	14	15	1
July 8-11, 2010	36	33	15	16	*
July 1-5, 2010	48	30	13	8	*
June 24-27, 2010	37	37	15	11	1
June 17-20, 2010	38	34	15	13	*
June 10-13, 2010	39	35	17	9	*
June 3-6, 2010	35	33	16	14	1
May 27-30, 2010	43	29	13	15	*
May 20-23, 2010	40	35	13	11	*
May 13-16, 2010	49	32	11	8	1
May 7-10, 2010	42	34	11	12	*
April 30-May 3, 2010	32	37	17	14	1
April 23-26, 2010	42	31	13	14	*
April 16-19, 2010	40	32	14	14	0
April 9-12, 2010	40	32	15	13	*
April 1-5, 2010	33	34	14	19	*
March 19-22, 2010	41	32	14	13	*
March 12-15, 2010	41	35	12	12	*
March 5-8, 2010	40	34	12	13	*
February 26-March 1, 2010	31	33	17	19	*
February 19-22, 2010	38	34	15	12	*
February 12-15, 2010	35	34	15	16	*
February 5-8, 2010	43	36	13	9	*
January 29-February 1, 2010	45	32	13	10	*
January 22-25, 2010	41	34	14	10	*
January 15-18, 2010	37	38	14	11	*
January 8-11, 2010	39	33	15	12	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
December 18-21, 2009	45	31	14	10	0
December 11-14, 2009	42	31	14	13	*
December 4-7, 2009	41	36	13	9	1
November 13-16, 2009	38	33	14	15	*
October 30-November 2, 2009	34	32	17	16	*
October 23-26, 2009	44	30	15	10	1
October 9-12, 2009	41	29	16	13	*
October 2-5, 2009	44	30	15	11	0
September 25-28, 2009	44	37	10	10	*
September 18-21, 2009	44	34	15	7	*
September 11-14, 2009	45	32	14	9	*
September 3-6, 2009	41	31	15	13	*
August 28-31, 2009	45	30	13	12	1
August 21-24, 2009	50	27	13	10	1
August 14-17, 2009	41	37	11	12	*
August 7-10, 2009	42	34	13	10	*
July 31-August 3, 2009	46	34	11	8	*
July 24-27, 2009	45	35	12	8	*
July 17-20, 2009	43	35	11	11	1
July 10-13, 2009	37	38	13	11	*
July 2-5, 2009	38	35	15	12	*
June 19-22, 2009	42	33	15	10	*
June 12-15, 2009	41	35	12	12	*
June 5-8, 2009	41	34	11	14	*
May 29-June 1, 2009	43	37	11	8	*
May 21-24, 2009	44	35	13	9	*
May 15-18, 2009	44	35	12	8	*
May 8-11, 2009	42	34	12	12	*
May 1-4, 2009	47	36	11	5	1
April 17-20, 2009	52	30	10	7	1
April 9-13, 2009	48	29	13	10	0
March 27-30, 2009	48	32	10	10	*
March 20-23, 2009	52	34	8	6	*
March 13-16, 2009	48	33	9	10	*
February 27-March 2, 2009	56	30	8	6	*
February 13-16, 2009	55	29	10	6	*
January 30-February 2, 2009	52	31	12	5	*
January 23-26, 2009	57	30	8	5	0
January 16-19, 2009	43	35	13	9	*
January 2-4, 2009	42	36	15	7	*
December 12-15, 2008	51	33	9	7	*
December 5-8, 2008	42	38	13	7	*
November 21-24, 2008	59	24	9	8	*
November 14-17, 2008	56	29	9	6	*
November 7-10, 2008	54	31	8	7	*
October 31-November 3, 2008	63	27	6	4	*
October 24-27, 2008	52	35	7	5	1
October 17-20, 2008	62	29	6	3	*
October 10-13, 2008	65	25	7	3	*
October 3-6, 2008	69	23	5	3	*
September 26-29, 2008	70	22	5	3	*
September 19-22, 2008	56	27	12	5	*
September 5-8, 2008	44	33	16	7	*
August 29-31, 2008	41	34	13	11	1
August 15-18, 2008	39	36	15	10	*
August 8-11, 2008	39	35	16	10	*
August 1-4, 2008	47	34	11	8	0
July 25-28, 2008	46	32	10	12	*
July 18-21, 2008	45	33	13	9	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
July 11-14, 2008	44	33	12	10	1
June 27-30, 2008	49	31	12	7	1
June 13-16, 2008	42	33	14	11	*
May 9-12, 2008	45	31	13	11	*
May 2-5, 2008	43	31	15	10	1
April 18-21, 2008	41	35	13	10	1
April 4-7, 2008	39	37	12	12	*
March 28-31, 2008	42	36	14	8	*
March 20-24, 2008	45	33	13	9	*
February 29-March 3, 2008	38	35	15	11	1
February 15-18, 2008	37	36	11	16	8
February 1-4, 2008	40	37	14	8	1
January 18-21, 2008	42	31	16	11	*
January 11-14, 2008	36	32	15	16	1
November 2-5, 2007	27	37	16	19	1
October 19-22, 2007	25	34	20	21	*
August 10-13, 2007	28	36	18	18	*
Mid-November, 2006	31	40	17	11	1
December, 2005	35	35	18	11	1
Early November, 2005	35	39	17	9	*
Mid-May, 2005	30	39	19	11	1
January, 2005	35	41	17	7	*
Mid-October, 2004	30	43	16	10	1
Early September, 2004	39	34	15	11	1
Mid-January, 2004	37	41	15	7	*
December, 2003	35	38	14	11	2
November, 2003	40	34	15	10	1
October, 2003	32	39	16	12	1
September, 2003	39	30	18	12	1
March, 2003	40	35	16	8	1
February, 2003	42	33	15	10	*
December, 2002	38	34	17	10	1
February, 2002	35	40	15	9	1
January, 2002	30	44	16	9	1
December, 2001	37	40	13	8	2
Mid-November, 2001	41	36	15	7	1
June, 2001	24	41	18	16	1
May, 2001	34	36	15	15	0
April, 2001	36	34	16	13	1
February, 2001	30	39	18	12	1
January, 2001	32	38	17	11	2
June, 1995	26	41	22	11	*
March, 1995	27	45	19	9	*
February, 1995	23	41	22	13	1
December, 1994	28	43	20	9	*
October, 1994	27	40	20	12	1
June, 1994	25	42	23	10	*
May, 1994	33	40	16	10	1
January, 1994	34	39	16	10	1
Early January, 1994	36	44	13	7	*
December, 1993	35	41	15	8	1
October, 1993	33	38	20	9	*
September, 1993	37	40	14	8	1
Early September, 1993	39	39	14	9	*
August, 1993	41	36	14	9	*
May, 1993	37	38	18	6	1
February, 1993	49	36	10	5	*
January, 1993	42	39	12	7	*
September, 1992	43	37	13	6	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May, 1992	39	39	15	6	1
March, 1992	47	38	11	4	*
February, 1992	47	37	10	6	*
January, 1992	44	40	11	5	*
October, 1991	36	38	16	9	1
b. Winter storms in the Eastern U.S.					
January 13-16, 2011	35	32	17	16	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
December 16-19, 2010: *Cold winter weather*	43	27	13	16	1
February 12-15, 2010: *Major snow storms affecting the East Coast and the South*	39	31	16	14	*
January 8-11, 2010: *Unusually cold winter weather*	42	30	17	12	*
January 16-19, 2009: *Cold winter weather in much of the country*	33	31	21	15	*
December 14-17, 2007: *Snow and ice storms in the Midwest and Northeast*	30	31	21	18	*
February 16-19, 2007: *Cold winter weather and snowstorms in the Northeast and Midwest*	30	33	18	18	1
February 9-12, 2007: *Cold winter weather*	36	36	15	13	*
January 19-22, 2007: *Snow and ice storms in some parts of the country*	31	32	22	14	1
January 5-8, 2007: *Winter snowstorms in the western U.S.*	24	30	25	21	*
January, 2001: *Cold winter weather and storms in the Northeast and Midwest*	42	31	15	11	1
January, 1999: *Cold winter weather and storms in the Midwest*	37	34	17	12	*
Early December, 1998*: Unseasonable weather patterns*	39	35	13	12	1
January, 1994: *News about cold weather conditions in the Northeast and Midwest*	51	30	12	7	*
c. Floods in Australia					
January 13-16, 2011	13	26	23	37	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
August 19-22, 2010: *The flooding in Pakistan and its aftermath*	11	23	32	33	1
August 12-15, 2010: *Floods in Pakistan*	8	19	30	43	1
March 12-15, 2010: *Major aftershocks in Chile following an earthquake in late February*	18	41	27	14	*
March 5-8, 2010: *A major earthquake in Chile*	27	42	19	12	*
February 12-15, 2010: *The aftermath of a major earthquake and relief efforts in Haiti*	37	37	17	8	*
February 5-8, 2010	42	39	13	6	*
January 29-February 1, 2010	45	38	13	4	*
January 22-25, 2010	50	40	8	3	*
January 15-18, 2010: *A major earthquake in Haiti*	60	28	8	4	*
August 14-17, 2009: *A typhoon that caused flooding and mudslides in Taiwan*	7	21	30	41	1
April 9-13, 2009: *A major earthquake in Italy*	18	35	25	22	*
May 16-19, 2008: *The earthquake in China*	30	41	17	12	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May 9-12, 2008: *Reports about the cyclone that hit Burma*	23	35	23	19	*
November 2-5, 2007: *The impact of Hurricane Noel on the Bahamas and Cuba*	11	22	31	35	1
September 7-10, 2007: *The impact of Hurricanes Felix and Henriette on Mexico and Central America*	14	29	29	27	1
August 24-27, 2007: *The destruction caused by Hurricane Dean in Mexico and the Caribbean*	18	39	24	18	1
October, 2005: *The earthquake in Pakistan*	22	39	23	16	*
January 2005: *The earthquake and tsunami in the Indian Ocean*	58	32	7	3	*
January 2004: *The earthquake in Iran*	16	34	31	19	*
February 2001: *The earthquake in India*	15	33	31	20	1
March 2000: *Flood rescue efforts in Mozambique*	10	26	30	34	*
September 1999: *The earthquake in Turkey*	27	37	23	12	1
November 1998: *Hurricane Mitch and the rain and mudslides in Central America*	36	36	16	11	1
February 1995: *The earthquake in Japan*	25	47	20	8	*
May 1991: *The cyclone that devastated Bangladesh*	23	36	23	17	1
July 1990: *The earthquake in Iran*	20	36	28	16	*
d. News about a Congresswoman and others shot in Tucson, Arizona					
January 13-16, 2011	49	28	12	11	1
January 9, 2011[1]	31	33	13	23	1
e. The independence vote in southern Sudan					
January 13-16, 2011	3	11	19	65	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
March 6-9, 2009: *An arrest warrant for the president of Sudan on charges of war crimes in Darfur*	9	19	24	48	*
June 1-4, 2007: *Ethnic Violence in the Darfur region of Sudan*	12	22	29	36	1
December, 2006	13	23	29	34	1
May, 2006	16	22	27	33	2
July, 2004: *Ethnic Violence in Sudan*	14	22	27	35	2
f. The collapse of the Lebanese government					
January 13-16, 2011	4	11	20	64	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
May 24-27, 2007: *Violence in Lebanon between militant groups and the Lebanese army*	15	24	28	32	1
August 9-13, 2006: *The military conflict between Israel and Hezbollah forces in Lebanon*	40	34	14	10	2
March 17-21, 2005: *Protests and political changes in Lebanon*	10	28	25	36	1

[1] Question asked about "news about a congresswoman shot in Tucson, Arizona," and was asked on January 9, 2011, only, following the shooting on January 8.

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
April 19-25, 1996: *The military conflict between Israel and the pro-Iranian Muslims in Lebanon*	21	31	29	19	*

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.**

Jan 13-16 2011	
49	News about a Congresswoman and others shot in Tucson, Arizona
16	Winter storms in the Eastern U.S.
12	Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy
3	Floods in Australia
1	The collapse of the Lebanese government
*	The independence vote in southern Sudan
7	Some other story **(VOL.)**
12	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:

Thinking about the shooting in Tucson, Arizona last week…

PEW.3 Do you think this shooting reflects broader problems in American society, or are things like this just the isolated acts of troubled individuals?

Jan 13-16 2011		**TREND FOR COMPARISON:** April 18-22 2007[2]
31	Broader problems	46
58	Isolated acts	47
12	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	7

[2] Question was asked after the shooting at Virginia Tech and asked about "this shooting and others like it."

IF PEW.3= 1 ("BROADER PROBLEMS"), ASK [N=307]:

PEW.4 Just in your own view, what broader problems does this shooting reflect? **[OPEN END; ACCEPT UP TO THREE RESPONSES; DO NOT PROBE FOR ADDITIONAL]**

Jan 13-16
2011

27 SOCIAL CLIMATE (NET)
- 8 Breakdown of society (general)
- 6 Poor child rearing/Bad family/Bad kids/Bad education system
- 4 Lack of civility/respect
- 3 Feelings of frustration/discontent/hopelessness (general)
- 2 Lack of religion/God pushed out of society
- 2 Lack of discipline/self control
- 2 Anger
- 2 Lack of morals
- 1 Stupidity

21 POLITICAL/MEDIA CLIMATE (NET)
- 11 Partisan hatred/Political divisiveness
- 7 Dissatisfaction/upset with government
- 2 Polarizing rhetoric
- 2 Media coverage of politics/Talk show hosts
- 2 Extremists within the Republican Party/The Republican Party is to blame

14 Lack of mental health services/Mental health problems
13 Lack of gun control/access to guns
9 Dissatisfaction/upset with economy/unemployment
6 Violence (general)
1 Security issues
17 Other
8 Don't know/Refused

Figures add to more than 100% because of multiple responses.

TREND FOR COMPARISON: Virginia Tech Shooting
April 18-22
2007

37 MORALITY/SOCIAL VALUES (NET)
- 11 Moral breakdown / People don't know right from wrong
- 9 Violence in society/Movies/TV/Music/Video games
- 9 Family breakdown / Children neglected
- 5 Lack of community / No one cares or pays attention
- 5 Youth out of control / Selfish / No discipline
- 3 Lack of religion

23 SOCIAL/GOVERNMENT SYSTEM FAILURES (NET)
- 13 Mental health system not helping those in need
- 5 Legal system / Laws don't allow these people to be locked up
- 3 Not enough security
- 3 School system failing

14 Gun laws/Too easy to get guns

12 SOCIAL/PERSONAL PRESSURES (NET)
- 4 Social alienation / Isolation / Despair
- 3 Young people can't cope / High-pressure/fast-paced society breeds insecurity
- 2 Rich-poor divide breeds anger
- 2 Racial divisions / Minorities face pressures
- 1 Bullying

5 Copycat violence / Media coverage glorifies/sensationalizes
4 Crazy people in the world / He was crazy
2 Immigration
7 Other
11 Don't know/Refused
[N=687]

ASK ALL:

PEW.5 All things considered….these days have you been hearing too much, too little, or the right amount about Sarah Palin?

Jan 13-16 2011		Nov 20-23 2009	July 10-13 2009	Oct 24-27 2008[3]
49	Too much	52	38	46
15	Too little	13	18	18
29	Right amount	26	40	33
7	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	9	4	3

ASK ALL:

PEW.6 How much, if anything, have you seen or heard about **[INSERT; RANDOMIZE]**

		A lot	A little	Nothing at all	**(Vol.)** Don't know
a.	Barack Obama's speech at the memorial for victims of the Arizona shooting January 13-16, 2011	37	38	25	1
b.	Sarah Palin's comments on the Arizona shooting January 13-16, 2011	19	39	40	1

RANDOMIZE PEW.7 AND PEW.8
IF HEARD 'A LOT' OR 'A LITTLE' ABOUT OBAMA'S SPEECH (PEW.6a=1,2) [N=778]:

PEW.7 How would you rate Barack Obama's speech in Arizona… **[READ]?**

Jan 13-16 2011	
36	Excellent
33	Good
15	Only fair [OR]
6	Poor
10	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

RANDOMIZE PEW.7 AND PEW.8
IF HEARD 'A LOT' OR 'A LITTLE' ABOUT PALIN's COMMENTS (PEW.6b=1,2) [N=641]:

PEW.8 What was your reaction to Sarah Palin's comments… **[READ]**?

Jan 13-16 2011	
14	Very positive
30	Mostly positive
21	Mostly negative
20	Very negative
15	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

NO PEW.9 OR PEW.10

[3] For October 24-27, 2008 this item was asked as part of a list of candidates.

ASK ALL:
Next,
PEW.11 In general, how interested are you in news about what happens in **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**?

	Very interested	Somewhat interested	Not too interested	Not at all interested	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Indonesia					
January 13-16, 2011	7	29	27	36	2
b. Nicaragua					
January 13-16, 2011	8	30	24	36	1
c. Russia					
January 13-16, 2011	14	35	19	30	2
d. Spain					
January 13-16, 2011	8	32	25	34	1
e. Sweden					
January 13-16, 2011	5	28	27	38	2
f. Kenya					
January 13-16, 2011	10	31	24	34	1
g. Venezuela					
January 13-16, 2011	9	31	25	34	2

ASK ALL:
PEW.12 What do you think is more important—to protect the right of Americans to own guns, OR to control gun ownership?

	Protect right to own guns	Control gun ownership	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
January 13-16, 2011	49	46	6
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010	46	50	4
Mar 10-14, 2010	46	46	7
Mar 31-Apr 1, 2009	45	49	6
Apr, 2008	37	58	5
Nov, 2007	42	55	3
Apr, 2007	32	60	8
Feb, 2004	37	58	5
Jun, 2003	42	54	4
May, 2000	38	57	5
Apr, 2000	37	55	8
Mar, 2000	29	66	5
Jun, 1999	33	62	5
May, 1999	30	65	5
Dec, 1993	34	57	9